



IDX G9 HISTORY H STUDY GUIDE ISSUE S2

FINALS

By Ava and Lola, Edited by Maggie

NOTE: This is an official document by Indexademics. Unless otherwise stated, this document may not be accredited to individuals or groups other than the club IDX, nor should this document be distributed, sold, or modified for personal use in any way.

This guide is a combined guide. Due to the final range including content from before the monthlies, we have included content from the previous issue in this guide for your convenience.

Mesoamerica

The Olmec Civilization (1400-300 BCE)

- First civilization in Mesoamerica, called themselves the “Xi” people
- “Mother Culture” → spread to other cultures after them
- First to use stone in art and architecture
- Temple and art → powerful priests and nobles
- Colossal Heads → 5-11 ft tall
- Technological Advances
 - o Magnetic compasses
 - o Complex drainage, sewer systems
 - o Complex irrigation and urban piping
 - o Metallurgy
 - o Astronomy → cities even arranged by stars
- Influence
 - o Trade with neighbors
 - o Cultural diffusion → jaguars, serpents, calendars, hieroglyphics
- Society + Religion
 - o Chief = highest rank; few “status” positions
 - o Collective labor force
 - o Ball game
 - o Religion and society = one
 - o Polytheistic and Animistic religion
 - o 10 deities with dual characteristics
 - o Blood letting and human sacrifice
 - o Jaguars (rulers), snakes, crocs, sharks
 - o Shamans and healers → assumed animal powers

- Decline → few decipherable written records → nobody really knows how they declined

Zapotecs (500 BCE – 1000)

- Similar traditions to Olmecs
 - o Small ruling class, aggressive conquerors, human sacrifice, hieroglyphics that recorded conquests, ball games
- First great stone pyramid builders
- Center: monte alban
- Efficient agriculture plus advanced irrigation system = population boom
- Major city → monte alban and san jose mongote
- Calendars, pyramids, temples, palaces, observatory, stone sculptures like Olmecs

The Mayans

- Influenced by the Olmecs
- Farming → “Slash and Burn”, raised fields along riverbanks (actually not effective and nutrition draining)
- Massive surplus at height → population boom!
 - o Chultunes → underground granaries
- Powerful city-states
- Never an empire, not politically united, but regularly traded
 - o Honey salt, cotton, cacao
 - o Feathers, jade, jaguar pelts
- Religion
 - o Sacrifice; people who were captured in battle
 - o Worshipped hundreds of gods (with overlap in duties)
 - o Human sacrifices for important events
 - o Kings and priests propitiated gods
- Astronomy
 - o Ritual calendar (260 days) and Solar Calendar (365 days)
- Decline
 - o Abandoned cities 900 CE
 - o 1500, mostly villages
 - o Nobody knows what caused the decline

Teotihuacan (100-650)

- Pyramids
- Aztecs called it “place of the gods”
- Writing and language didn’t survive
- Obsidian, rubber, cacao, feather, food, pulque (liquor)
- City of gods
 - o Largest city around 200000 people, with temples, markets, workshops, residences
 - o Borrowed from Olmecs → ball games and calendar
 - o Religiously and astronomically planned
 - o Floating gardens and irrigation

Toltecs

- Various groups in relative isolation formed an empire
- Capital at Tula (968)
- Influence beyond central Mexico
- Trade with American Southwest
- Quetzal Coatl

- Militaristic society/conquest state
- Ruled by 2 chieftains
- Agrarian and trade: feather, jade, gold, obsidian, etc.
- Human sacrifice
- Decline 1122, unknown.

The Aztecs

- Valley of Mexico = high plateau of central Mexico
- Mexica
 - o Group who migrated from the North (early 13th century)
 - o Spoke Nahuatl
 - o 1325 – founded Tenochtitlan
 - o 1434 – conquered surrounding city-states
- Founding of Tenochtitlan
 - o Aztec legend
 - o Lake Texcoco → swampy lake
- Triple Alliance: Mexica – Tenochtitlan, Texcoco, Tlacopan
- 5-6 million
- Tribute → allowed them to build up Tenochtitlan
- Flower Wars: intermittent ritual war between Triple Alliance and subject city-states, rival neighbors for years
 - o Combatants met at predetermined sites with equal numbers of forces
 - o Small-scale battles with melee weapons to show individual skill
 - o Generally less deadly than real wars
- Tenochtitlan
 - o Influenced by city of Tenochtitlan
 - o Well-planned
 - o Pyramid of Sun and Moon
 - o Site where gods made the Aztecs world
- Government and Society
 - o Single ruler → elected by a council of nobles, priests and military leaders
 - o Noble administration
 - o Warriors
 - o Priests
- Aztec Economy
 - o Agrarian
 - o Man-made floating islands able to yield large amount of crops
 - Organized by clans
 - Maize and beans
 - o Vibrant daily markets regulated by the State
- Aztec Religion
 - o Polytheistic
 - o Huitzilopochtli → patron god of Aztecs
 - Deity of war and sun
 - Patron of Tenochtitlan
 - o Nanahuatzin → sacrificed himself to become the sun
 - Sacrifices made to give strength to the sun
 - Usually prisoners of war
 - o Quetzalcoatl → feathered serpent god
 - Learning, culture
- Aztec knowledge

- Historical records → hieroglyphics
- Calendar inspired by the mayans
- Medicine → almost entirely herbal

North America

-Eastern Woodlands

-Agriculture began in the third millennium BCE, focusing on maize, squash, beans, and grasses.

-Sedentary villages emerged, with councils to resolve disputes and some regions uniting under chiefs.

-Trade networks spanned from Lake Superior to the Gulf of Mexico, exchanging goods like meat, shells, and tools.

Cahokia

- A major urban center near modern-day East St. Louis, Illinois, with large earthen mounds.
- Served as an administrative and trade hub, with evidence of Mesoamerican influences (e.g., ball courts).
- Declined by the 12th century, possibly due to environmental or social factors.

Ancient Pueblo Peoples

- Developed agriculture in the arid Southwest (Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona).
- Built adobe pueblos (e.g., Chaco Canyon) with advanced irrigation systems and trade networks.
- Possible reasons for migration (13th century): drought, warfare, or external pressures (e.g., cannibalism evidence).
- Descendants include the Hopi and Zuni tribes. (all Hopi are Pueblo but not all Pueblo are Hopi)

South America

Caral (Peru)

- One of the earliest urban centers (2500 BCE), with pyramids, plazas, and astronomical structures. Arguably next to Mesopotamia, early civilization
- Practiced irrigation farming and traded with coastal communities (e.g., cotton, fish, reeds).
- Evidence of social stratification and cultural activities (music, crafts).

Chavín Culture

- Emerged in the first millennium BCE, known for stone temples and metallurgy (copper, gold).
- Declined by 200 BCE, leaving behind artistic and religious influences.

Moche (Peru, 1st millennium CE)

- Advanced civilization with adobe pyramids (e.g., Pyramid of the Sun) and intricate art (ceramics, metalwork).

- Focused on warfare, sacrifice, and astronomy (e.g., Ai Apaec, the "Decapitator God").
- Collapsed by the 8th century due to environmental disruptions (e.g., El Niño floods, drought), not well known about culture, survived by artifacts

Wari and Chimu Civilizations (Southern Peru)

- The Wari expanded into Moche territories as the Moche declined.
- The Chimu built Chan Chan, a large adobe city with advanced irrigation systems.
- Chimu civilization collapsed by the 15th century due to floods and earthquakes damaging their irrigation systems.

Environmental Impact on Civilizations:

- Climate changes (droughts, floods) contributed to the fall of the Moche, Mayan city-states, and possibly the Roman Empire.
- Overuse of land in Mesopotamia and Maya regions led to soil erosion and decline.
- El Niño caused alternating droughts and floods, damaging agriculture and fishing industries. (following this is La Niña, which brings hurricanes)

Cultural and Religious Practices:

- Moche rituals included human sacrifices to invoke rain or prevent disasters.
- The Wari adopted and repurposed Moche religious symbols and buildings.
- Precious artifacts were often placed in burial sites, reflecting cultural values.

14-1 An Age of Exploration and Expansion

- Europeans weren't the first in Asian trade; Indian Ocean trade had thrived for centuries.
- Vasco da Gama's voyage to India (late 15th century) is seen as a key moment, but Asian and African trade networks were already well - established. The Portuguese keep the route in secret until the Dutch discover them later.
- Muslim merchants had long dominated the spice trade, with trade routes connecting various regions.

Islam and the Spice Trade:

- Muslim merchants had been involved in the spice trade for centuries, sailing from ports in Asia. By the 13th century, Islam had a presence in Southeast Asian islands and was spreading inland.

-The spread of Islam in Southeast Asia was also influenced by new sultanates, like Malacca, founded in the early 15th century.

Spread of Islam in West Africa:

-Muslim commercial and religious influence spread south across the Sahara to the Niger River Valley.

-Muslim traders (Arabs and local converts) brought Islamic values, culture, and legal traditions, contributing to state formation (e.g., the kingdom of Mali).

The Great City of Timbuktu:

-Became a major commercial hub for trans - Saharan trade, dealing in gold, salt, and other goods.

-Had a well - developed social and economic system, with a significant Islamic scholarly community.

-Leo Africanus described its wealth, including trade in precious goods and the use of currency (such as cowrie shells and gold).

Motives for European Expansion:

-“God, Gold, and Glory”.

-Missionary efforts to spread Christianity, desire for wealth (gold, spices), and pursuit of fame and national glory.

-Technological advancements (e.g., better ships, navigational tools like the compass and astrolabe) enabled these voyages.

14-2 The Portuguese Maritime Empire:

Portuguese Exploration Start:

- Began exploring the western coast of Africa under Prince Henry the Navigator, aiming for gold trade, weakening Muslim states, and spreading Christianity.
- Established a school for navigators and built forts along the African coast.

Voyages to India:

- Vasco da Gama's voyage to India (1497 - 1499) was a milestone. He reached the port of Calicut, and his voyage was sponsored to break the Muslim monopoly on the spice trade.
- Subsequent Portuguese efforts included establishing trade posts and forts, like at Malacca, to control trade routes.

Success and Challenges:

- Succeeded initially due to a strong navy, advanced ships, and cannon technology.
- Faced challenges from Muslim rivals and later European competitors (e.g., Spain, England, Netherlands).
- Struggled to maintain dominance long - term due to over - extension, high costs, and competition.

Dividing Up the Spoils of Exploration:

- Portugal and Spain signed the Treaty of Tordesillas (1494) to divide newly discovered territories.
- The treaty set a line of demarcation, giving most of the Americas to Spain and areas east (including Africa and Asia) to Portugal, but later disputes arose over exact boundaries. This leads to several violations of the treaty in the future.

14-3 The Conquest of the “New World

- European Powers in the Americas

- Spanish Exploration and Conquest:

- Christopher Columbus (Italian sailing for Spain) reached the Americas in 1492, mistakenly believing he had reached Asia.

- Spanish conquistadors (e.g., Hernán Cortés in Mexico, Francisco Pizarro in Peru) conquered major indigenous empires (Aztec, Inca) using superior weapons, alliances with rival groups, and the spread of European diseases.

- Established a large colonial empire in the Americas, including areas like Mexico, Central America, and much of South America.

- Portuguese in Brazil:

- Portuguese explorer Pedro Cabral accidentally discovered Brazil in 1500.

- Established colonies, initially focusing on extracting gold and silver, and later on plantation - based agriculture (sugar, coffee).

- Developed a colonial administration system and a multiracial society (with European, indigenous, and African influences).

- Governing the Empires

- Spain and Portugal constructed colonial empires with administrative systems. Spain's included viceroyalties (e.g., New Spain, Peru) to govern large territories.

- Latin America became a multiracial society, with mestizos (European - indigenous mixed) and other mixed - race groups emerging due to intermarriage and African slavery. The closer to pure European blood you were, the higher was your social status.

- The Catholic Church played a major role in colonizing efforts, converting indigenous peoples, building missions, and influencing social and cultural life.

- Exploiting the Riches

- Europeans exploited the Americas' natural resources, especially gold and silver. Mines in Mexico, Peru, and Bolivia were major sources, with precious metals shipped to Europe, fueling economic growth.

- The encomienda system was instituted, where European settlers received land and indigenous labor, leading to exploitation and abuse of the indigenous population. Main purpose of system was to convert indigenous people to Christianity.

- African slaves were brought to the Americas to work on plantations (sugar, tobacco, etc.) as indigenous populations were decimated by disease and overwork.

- Opposing Viewpoints on European Exploration

- Some (e.g., Gonzalo Fernández de Oviedo) viewed European exploration as a “march of civilization,” bringing Christianity and progress.

- Others (e.g., Bartolomé de Las Casas) condemned the brutal treatment of indigenous peoples and the atrocities committed by conquistadors.

- Competition Intensifies

- Other European powers (English, Dutch, French) entered the competition for American colonies and trade. They established settlements, traded, and competed for resources in the Caribbean and North America.

- The Columbian Exchange, involving the transfer of plants, animals, diseases, and cultures between the Americas and the Old World, had both positive (e.g., new crops, increased food production) and negative (e.g., disease spread, indigenous population decline) impacts. The Europeans didn't suffer the same disease people as the indigenous because the indigenous people did not have plagues as they were all too separated from each other.

14-4 Africa in Transition

- Portuguese in Africa

- Portuguese initially aimed to find a sea route to the Spice Islands but also engaged in trade along the African coast, focusing on gold and later slaves.

- Seized East African port cities (e.g., Kilwa, Sofala, Mombasa) and built forts to control trade, especially in gold.

- The Slave Trade

- European exploration of the African coast led to a significant increase in the slave trade from the 16th to 18th centuries.

- Enslaved Africans were forcibly removed from their homes and exported to plantations in the Americas. Usually cash crop plantations: cotton, tobacco, sugarcane

- Slavery existed in Africa before European involvement, but the transatlantic slave trade expanded its scale and brutality.

- The Dutch, English, and French also became involved in the West African slave trade, competing with the Portuguese.

- European Settlement in Africa

- The Dutch were the first Europeans to settle in South Africa, establishing a colony at the Cape of Good Hope as a supply station.

- Their colony evolved, with Dutch farmers (Boers) and other European settlers, and later came into conflict with indigenous groups (e.g., Bantu - speaking peoples) over land and resources.

14-3 The Conquest of the “New World”

- Spanish & Portuguese Exploration

- Spain and Portugal led early European colonization of the Americas after Columbus' 1492 voyage.

- Conquistadors (e.g., Cortés in Mexico, Pizarro in Peru) defeated Aztec and Inca empires using weapons, alliances, and disease.

- Portugal established colonies in Brazil, focusing on sugar plantations and resource extraction.

- Colonial Governance & Society

- Spain created viceroyalties (e.g., New Spain) to rule vast territories; Portugal developed a colonial administration in Brazil.

- Latin America became multiracial, with mestizos (European - Indigenous) and mixed - race groups emerging.

- The Catholic Church played a key role in cultural and social control, converting Indigenous peoples and building missions.

- Exploitation & Slavery

- Europeans exploited gold, silver, and other resources (e.g., mines in Mexico, Peru).

- The *encomienda* system forced Indigenous labor; African slaves were imported to replace declining Indigenous populations.

- The transatlantic slave trade grew, with millions of Africans enslaved and transported to the Americas.

14-4 Africa in Transition

- European Involvement in Africa

- Portuguese initially sought trade routes but became involved in gold and slave trade along the African coast.

- Seized East African ports (e.g., Kilwa, Mombasa) to control trade; later, Dutch, English, and French joined the slave trade.

- The Slave Trade's Impact

- The transatlantic slave trade devastated African societies, displacing millions and disrupting economies.
- European merchants, local elites, and African intermediaries participated, often destabilizing kingdoms (e.g., Kongo).
- High mortality rates on the "Middle Passage" (voyage from Africa to Americas) and brutal conditions in the Americas characterized the trade.

14-5 Southeast Asia in the Era of the Spice Trade

- European Competition in Southeast Asia
 - Europeans (Portuguese, Dutch, English, French) competed for control of the spice trade, targeting Malacca and other key ports.
 - The Dutch East India Company (VOC) emerged dominant, pushing out rivals and controlling trade routes.
- Society & Culture in Precolonial Southeast Asia
 - Southeast Asian societies (e.g., Siam, Malacca) balanced local traditions with new influences (Islam, Buddhism).
 - Islam and Buddhism shaped political structures; trade (spices, textiles) drove economic growth.
 - European presence remained limited initially but grew, impacting local politics and culture over time.

The Protestant Reformation

- Europe Ca. 1500

- Reconquista finished by kingdoms of Aragon and Castile (Spain but 2 separate kingdoms)
- Italian city-states trade
- France was politically unified and stable under the House of Valois since the end of the Hundred Years' War
- Holy Roman Empire was somewhat decentralized, ruled by Maximilian I, the founder of Habsburg dynasty
 - Effectively hereditary, the emperors still had to be elected
 - Joanna of Aragon and Castile married Phillip the Handsome of Austria
- England was stabilized under Tudors (Henry)
- The Ottoman Empire was rising in the East
- The church in the 1500s
 - Popes meddled in political/secular affairs
 - Extreme wealth indulgences
 - Increased fees for marriage and baptisms
 - Some citizens felt squeezed, desired simpler church
 - Resentment of clerical privileges and immunities
- Martin Luther
 - Initially not opposed to the church
 - 1517 → wrote the 95 Theses
 - Argued that church couldn't save you for purgatory

- 1521 → excommunicated and outlawed but protected by Prince Frederick III
- Still gained support of people
- 1522 → publication of German translation of New Testament
- 1526 → English translation of New Testament
- Zwingli (1484-1531)
 - Ulrich Zwingli similar to Luther, based in Zurich
 - Scripture = sole basis of religious truth
 - Attacked indulgences, Mass, monasticism, clerical celibacy
- Protestantism
 - Salvation by faith alone → if you believe in God, you'll go to heaven
 - Priesthood of all believers → stressed critical importance of the Bible and that everyone could interpret it, weakens authority of the church
 - General rejection of elaborate church rituals
- Reformation Spreads
 - John Calvin established Protestant theocracy in Geneva ~1541
 - Calvinism spread through parts of France and Scotland
 - Some Calvinists in Scotland (and England eventually) become known as Puritans in France: Huguenots
 - Calvinists were not popular, which relates to St. Bartholomew Day's massacre. Practices were very strict and limiting ex. People were not allowed to dance

	Catholicism	Lutheranism	Calvinism
Salvation	Through faith and good works	Through faith	God predetermines who will be saved
Sacraments	7 rituals – Baptism, confirmation, marriage, ordination, communion, anointing the sick and repentance	Accepts some but rejects others; rituals can't erase sin, only God can	Accepts some but rejects others; rituals can't erase sin, only God can
Head	Pope	Ministers	Council of Elders
Bible	One source of truth, church tradition as well	Only source of truth	Only source of truth
How Belief is revealed	Priests interpret the Bible and Church teachings	People read and interpreted themselves	People read and interpreted themselves

- Anglican Church

- Henry VIII was Catholic, but his annulment was denied, establishes church to allow divorce
- 1534 Act of Supremacy
- 1535-39 Dissolution and destruction of monasteries

- Henry died leaving Edward VI a child
- Mary I of Scotland seized throne a staunch Catholic
 - Fears of religious violence, persecution
- 1558 Elizabeth I revised Act Supremacy 1559
 - Calmed tensions, protestant

European Wars of Religion (1530s – 1648)

- Habsburg Land 1550
 - After some religious conflict in Holy Roman Empire, Charles V divided lands
 - Ferdinand → Central Lands
 - Philip II → Spain, Italy, Netherlands
- French Wars of Religion (1562 – 1598)
 - St. Bartholomew's Day Massacre
 - 1562-1570 → three violent religious war between French Catholics and Protestants
 - 1570 Agreement → Henry IV of Navarre (P) married Margaret of Valois
 - 1572 → Huguenots came to Paris for the wedding
 - Assassination attempt on most military powerful Huguenot; other Huguenots feared a conspiracy
 - Royal council planned execution of Huguenot military leader other prominent Huguenots

- Violence explodes through Paris, and then through the French countryside
 - about 3000 killed in Paris, perhaps ten thousand across France Huguenots respond by revolting, intermittent fighting continued until 1594
- Tensions Ease
 - Henry IV of Navarre eventually inherited the throne of France, 1589
 - Won a series of battle vs. Catholic nobles, but couldn't take Paris
 - Converted to Catholicism in 1594, finally accepted by Catholic nobles
 - 1598: issued Edict of Nantes, granted Huguenots religious tolerance but gave them limited areas to practice.
- The Eighty Years War – Dutch Revolts and Independence (1568-1648)
 - Spain vs. Britain
 - Queen Elizabeth often tried to help the Netherlands
 - Phillip II responded → sent Spanish Armada to attempt invasion of England in 1588

Spanish ships smashed

- Spain versus Dutch
 - Tensions arise as Protestantism (Dutch) forbids idolatry, which Catholics (Spain) worships. Protestants destroy statues and paintings within churches, which infuriates the Spanish
 - Dutch fight against Spanish by flooding cities, forcing them to leave

